

The New York Symphony

FOUNDED 1921 · A NONPROFIT PERFORMING ARTS ORGANIZATION

Mission, Vision & Programs Overview

Prepared for the Office of the President & CEO · 2025

Who We Are

The New York Symphony is one of the nation’s leading orchestras, founded in 1921 and resident at Hudson Concert Hall in Manhattan. Across more than a century, the Symphony has performed for tens of millions of listeners, championed American composers, and built one of the most ambitious music-education programs in the country. Under the artistic leadership of Music Director Sofia Klein, the Symphony presents over 120 concerts each season and reaches an additional 90,000 students and community members through its education and engagement work.

“To enrich and inspire our community through the transformative power of orchestral music — on the concert stage, in our schools, and across the five boroughs.”

120+ CONCERTS / SEASON	98 MUSICIANS	320k ANNUAL AUDIENCE	1921 FOUNDED
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Our Vision

The Symphony aspires to be an indispensable cultural institution for New York — artistically excellent, financially resilient, and deeply connected to the communities it serves. Our long-range plan emphasizes three commitments: sustaining artistic excellence at the highest level; broadening access so that orchestral music belongs to everyone; and securing the institution’s future through disciplined stewardship of its endowment and a growing base of philanthropic support.

Core Programs

Subscription & Concert Series

The heart of the Symphony’s work is its classical subscription season at Hudson Concert Hall, complemented by pops, family, and chamber series, guest-artist recitals, and an annual summer residency. The Symphony also tours nationally and internationally, carrying New York’s cultural reputation abroad.

Education & Community Engagement

- **Symphony in the Schools** — teaching-artist residencies and curriculum partnerships reaching 140 public schools across the five boroughs.
- **Young People's Concerts** — a century-old tradition introducing students to live orchestral music, serving more than 40,000 children annually.
- **Concerts in the Parks** — free outdoor performances each summer drawing audiences of over 50,000.
- **Fellowship & Pipeline programs** — supporting the development of musicians from historically underrepresented backgrounds.

The Role of the Endowment

The Symphony's endowment is the financial foundation that allows it to take artistic risks, keep ticket prices accessible, and sustain its education programs through economic cycles. The endowment currently stands at approximately **\$186 million** and provides roughly one-fifth of the Symphony's annual operating support through a disciplined spending policy. A significant portion of the endowment is donor-restricted — supporting named chairs, guest-artist series, and education initiatives — and is managed in accordance with the wishes of the donors who established those funds.

Performing-arts organizations rely on a blend of earned revenue (ticket sales and touring), contributed revenue (annual giving, grants, and gala support), and endowment income. Because earned revenue rarely covers more than half of the cost of presenting live orchestral music, the endowment's reliable support is essential to the Symphony's mission and stability.

Leadership

- **Sofia Klein** — Music Director
- **Marcus Bell** — President & Chief Executive Officer
- **Eleanor Vance** — Chair, Board of Directors
- **Patricia Nolan** — Chief Financial Officer
- **Robert Kim** — Chair, Finance & Investment Committee